

Cancer & Oncology-Related Drug Shortages — FDA Drug Shortage Database

Generated: 2026-06-20 19:58 | Source: openFDA Drug Shortages API | openFDA metadata last updated: 2026-03-21 | Individual shortage records may have later update dates | Total FDA shortage records: 1,637

The FDA Drug Shortage Database tracks drugs for which nationwide supply falls short of demand. This report filters the full database to oncology and cancer-related drugs — including chemotherapy agents, supportive-care medications (antiemetics, corticosteroids, hematologic support drugs), hormone therapies, and other medications commonly used in cancer treatment protocols. All data sourced directly from openFDA. No opinion. No advocacy. #FollowTheData

CANCER-RELATED DRUGS
IN SHORTAGE

36

12.0% of all FDA
shortages

189 shortage records · 1,637
total in FDA database

MEDIAN SHORTAGE
DURATION

3.1 yrs

mean: 3.1 yrs

Longest active: 8.6 years

SHORTAGES > 1 YEAR

9

of 36 unique drugs

25% lasting over 12 months

RESOLVED /
DISCONTINUED

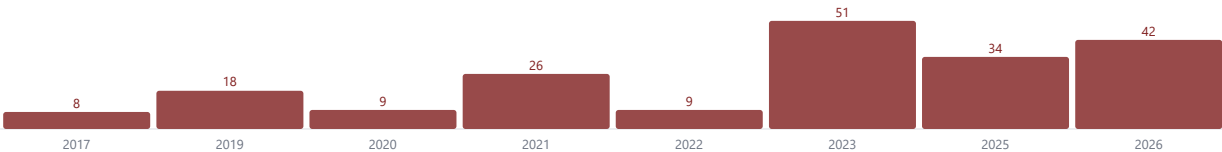
8 / 0

in FDA database

Resolved = supply restored ·
Disc = no longer marketed

NEW SHORTAGES REPORTED BY YEAR

OPENFDA · INITIAL_POSTING_DATE · DETERMINISTIC



CANCER THERAPEUTICS IN SHORTAGE — SORTED BY DURATION

OPENFDA · DETERMINISTIC ·

CHEMOTHERAPY & TARGETED THERAPY

Drug (Generic Name)	Dosage Form	Availability	Mfrs Affected	First Reported	Duration
Azacitidine Injection	Injection	Some Unavailable	9	2020-12-18	5.5 yrs
Streptozocin Powder, For Solution	Powder, For Solution	Some Unavailable	2	2022-07-12	3.9 yrs
Methotrexate Sodium Injection	Injection	Some Unavailable	5	2023-03-13	3.3 yrs
Carboplatin Injection	Injection	Some Unavailable	9	2023-04-28	3.1 yrs

Drug (Generic Name)	Dosage Form	Availability	Mfrs Affected	First Reported	Duration
Docetaxel Injection	Injection	Available	2	2025-06-24	361d
Pemetrexed Ditromethamine Injection	Injection	Available	1	2025-07-17	338d
Irinotecan Hydrochloride Injection	Injection	Available	3	2025-08-04	320d
Methotrexate Injection	Injection	Available	1	2025-08-29	295d
Gemcitabine Hydrochloride Injection	Injection	Available	1	2025-09-11	282d
Pemetrexed Disodium Injection	Injection	Available	2	2025-10-10	253d
Oxaliplatin Injection	Injection	Available	2	2025-10-20	243d
Busulfan Injection	Injection	Available	1	2025-10-24	239d
Deferiprone Tablet	Tablet	Available	1	2025-11-07	225d
Anagrelide Hydrochloride Capsule	Capsule	Available	1	2025-11-19	213d
Nilutamide Tablet	Tablet	Available	1	2025-12-01	201d
Allopurinol Tablet	Tablet	Available	1	2026-02-19	121d
Decitabine Injection	Injection	Available	1	2026-02-20	120d
Arsenic Trioxide Injection	Injection	Available	1	2026-02-24	116d
Plerixafor Injection	Injection	Available	1	2026-03-13	99d
Tazemetostat Hydrobromide Tablet	Tablet	Available	1	2026-03-27	85d
Idelalisib Tablet	Tablet	Available	1	2026-04-07	74d
Palbociclib Capsule	Capsule	Available	1	2026-04-22	59d
Alteplase Injection	Injection	Available	1	2026-05-21	30d
Dacomitinib Tablet	Tablet	Available	1	2026-06-08	12d
Ifosfamide Injection	Injection	Some Unavailable	3	2026-06-12	8d
Lorlatinib Tablet	Tablet	Available	1	2026-06-15	5d

SUPPORTIVE-CARE DRUGS IN SHORTAGE — SORTED BY DURATION

OPENFDA · DETERMINISTIC ·

CORTICOSTEROIDS, ANTICOAGULANTS & OTHER ONCOLOGY SUPPORT

Drug (Generic Name)	Dosage Form	Availability	Mfrs Affected	First Reported	Duration
Heparin Sodium Injection	Injection	Some Unavailable	4	2017-11-14	8.6 yrs
Dexamethasone Sodium Phosphate Injection	Injection	Some Unavailable	5	2019-02-08	7.4 yrs
Desmopressin Acetate Spray	Spray	Some Unavailable	2	2021-03-12	5.3 yrs

Drug (Generic Name)	Dosage Form	Availability	Mfrs Affected	First Reported	Duration
Methylprednisolone Acetate Injection	Injection	Some Unavailable	5	2021-12-15	4.5 yrs
Flurazepam Hydrochloride Capsule	Capsule	Some Unavailable	2	2022-08-03	3.9 yrs
Fondaparinux Sodium Injection	Injection	Available	1	2025-09-29	264d
Fosaprepitant Dimeglumine Injection	Injection	Available	1	2026-04-08	73d
Aprepitant Oral Powder for Suspension	—	Available	1	2026-04-08	73d
Icatibant Acetate Injection	Injection	Available	1	2026-05-07	44d
Iron Sucrose Injection	Injection	Available	1	2026-05-21	30d

Duration shown in years for shortages >365 days, days otherwise. Red = >2 years · Amber = >1 year · Green = <1 year. Data reflects FDA shortage status as of 2026-03-21.

AVAILABILITY STATUS

FDA SHORTAGE RECORDS · NOT UNIQUE DRUGS

Status	Records	% of 120 with known status
Available	57	47.5%
Unavailable	42	35.0%
Limited Availability	21	17.5%

69 of 189 records have no availability field set in openFDA and are excluded from percentages above.

TOP MANUFACTURERS FDA

SHORTAGE RECORDS · NOT UNIQUE DRUGS

Company	Records	% of 189
Pfizer Inc.	23	12.2%
Fresenius Kabi USA, LLC	22	11.6%
Hospira, Inc., a Pfizer Company	18	9.5%
Teva Pharmaceuticals USA, Inc.	17	9.0%
Ingenus Pharmaceuticals LLC	9	4.8%

BY DOSAGE FORM

FDA SHORTAGE RECORDS · NOT UNIQUE DRUGS

Form	Count	%
Injection	158	83.6%
Tablet	14	7.4%
Capsule	10	5.3%
Spray	4	2.1%
Powder, For Solution	2	1.1%

Injectable shortages are particularly critical for cancer patients who cannot substitute oral alternatives. Records with no dosage form field in openFDA appear as Unknown.

Data Source: FDA Drug Shortage Database accessed via openFDA public API (api.fda.gov/drug/shortages.json). No API key required. Data reflects shortages reported to FDA by manufacturers. The openFDA metadata timestamp reflects 2026-03-21; individual shortage records within the database carry their own update dates and may reflect activity through the report generation date.

Methodology: All 1,637 FDA shortage records fetched and filtered to cancer and oncology-related drugs — including chemotherapy agents, supportive-care medications (antiemetics, corticosteroids, hematologic support drugs), hormone therapies, and other medications commonly used in cancer treatment protocols. Drug classification by therapeutic category and name matching against a curated oncology drug list. No opinion. No forecasting. Same input always produces identical output. #FollowTheData · AI narrates. Data decides.

Access: This report is free and publicly accessible. Built on open-source Python using publicly available FDA data. No subscription. No paywall. Source: openFDA Drug Shortages API (api.fda.gov/drug/shortages.json).

Medical Disclaimer: This report is for informational purposes only and does not constitute medical advice. Consult a licensed healthcare provider for treatment decisions. Data accuracy is subject to FDA reporting completeness.